

Software Modernization Strategies

*32 approaches to revitalize
and right-size your legacy
system according to business
needs*

Categories:



Business



Development



Infrastructure



Enablement



Companion website:
**[feststelltaste.github.io/
littlestmodernization](https://feststelltaste.github.io/littlestmodernization)**

In

Ignore It!

Leave your system alone as
long as it does its job well.

K

Keep It Alive!

Keep your legacy system running, but make it a conscious choice, not a habit.

De

Delegate!

Hand off what is holding you
back and focus on what
actually matters.

G

Give It Away!

Open-source what you can no longer advance alone, and let the community share the load.

Si

Sell It!

Sell your legacy system to
someone for whom it is worth
more than it is to you.

Bn

Buy New!

Buy a ready-made solution
when someone else has already
solved your problem.

Sd

Shut It Down!

End your legacy system's
operation in a planned,
orderly, and drama-free way.

Cs

Consolidate It!

Replace your zoo of systems
with fewer, more manageable
units.

Sa

Standardize It!

Define how your systems are
built, connected, and
operated, and end the chaos.

H

Harmonize It!

Align your systems, models,
and processes so they work
together without friction.

Pn

Partner It!

Work with external partners
to evolve your system
together.

Bi

Bring It Back!

Take back control of your
system when outsourcing costs
more than it delivers.

Rt

Rethink It!

Do not question your system,
question the assumptions it
was built on.

Rm

Remodel It!

Align your system's structure
with the domain as you
understand it today.

T

Trim it down!

Remove what nobody needs
anymore and give your system
its actual purpose back.

Ip

Improve It!

Keep your system fit through
continuous, unspectacular work
before the debt catches up
with you.

Cv

Convert it!

Keep your system's proven
logic and only swap out the
technology it lives in.

F

Fork It!

Split off part of your system
and turn it into a standalone,
independent solution.

Rp

Repurpose It!

Deploy your system for a new audience instead of maintaining it for a shrinking market.

Sv

Salvage It!

Keep the valuable components
of your legacy system and
leave the rest behind.

W

Wrap it!

Leave the core untouched and
only modernize how your system
talks to the outside world.

Ri

Replace it!

Build new when the old system
is more burden than value.

Dv

Divide It!

Cut your system along its natural boundaries so one change no longer puts the whole system at risk.

E

Extract!

Pull the knowledge out of
your system before you take
the next step.

Ps

Preserve it!

Preserve your system so you
can still start it when
needed, without actively
maintaining it.

Rf

Replatform it!

Give your system a new foundation when the code is still good but what is underneath no longer is.

Rh

Rehost it!

Move your system to a new environment and leave everything else as it is.

Ug

Upgrade Tools!

Bring your tooling up to date
so legacy work becomes more
efficient.

A

Align Strategy!

Align your organization's strategic direction toward a realistic approach to legacy.

Rs

Reshape Org!

Reshape teams,
responsibilities, and
incentives so legacy work
finally works well.

Us

Upskill People!

Invest in the people you
already have before investing
in new technology.

Im

Improve Processes!

Improve not the system, but
the way your team works with
it.